

Passive with Two Objects

CEFR B2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Verbs with two objects (give, send, offer, show...) allow two passives:

- 1 Person as subject (more natural) — I was given a prize.
- 2 Thing as subject (less common) — A prize was given to me.

When the thing is the subject, add 'to' before the person: A letter was sent to her. Common verbs: give, send, offer, tell, show, pay, teach, lend, promise.

At a glance

Passive	Naturalness	Example
person as subject	more natural	I was given a prize.
thing as subject	less common (+ to)	A prize was given to me.

Learning objectives

- Can form both passives from a two-object verb (CEFR B2).
- Can prefer the person-as-subject version where natural.
- Can add 'to' before the person when the thing is the subject.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Passive with Two Objects · CEFR B2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. Make it passive (person first): 'They gave me a medal.'

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| A. I was given a medal. | B. A medal was given me. |
| C. I was gave a medal. | D. Me was given a medal. |

2. Make it passive (thing first): 'They sent her a parcel.'

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| A. A parcel was sent to her. | B. A parcel was sent her. |
| C. A parcel was send to her. | D. Her was sent a parcel. |

3. 'The company offered him a job.' → (natural passive)

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| A. He was offered a job. | B. A job was offered him. |
| C. He was offer a job. | D. Him was offered a job. |

4. 'Someone has told us the news.' → (person first)

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| A. We have been told the news. | B. The news has been told us. |
| C. We have been telled the news. | D. Us have been told the news. |

5. Add the missing word: 'A letter was sent ____ every customer.'

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| A. to | B. for |
| C. at | D. by |

6. 'They will show the visitors the garden.' → (person first, future)

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| A. The visitors will be shown the garden. | B. The garden will be shown the visitors. |
| C. The visitors will be show the garden. | D. The visitors are shown the garden tomorrow. |

7. Correct this: 'I was given me a second chance.'

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| A. I was given a second chance. | B. I was given to me a second chance. |
| C. Me was given a second chance. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

8. Correct this: 'A prize was given the winner.'

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|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A. A prize was given to the winner. | B. A prize was given for the winner. |
| C. A prize was gave to the winner. | D. The winner was given to a prize. |

9. Which passive is usually more natural in English?

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| A. The one starting with the person (She was sent an email). | B. The one starting with the thing (An email was sent to her). |
| C. They are equally natural in every case. | D. Neither; two-object verbs have no passive. |

10. Which verb does NOT normally take two objects?

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| A. arrive | B. give |
| C. send | D. offer |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. I was given a medal.** — Person as subject: 'I was given a medal'.
2. **A. A parcel was sent to her.** — Thing as subject needs 'to': 'A parcel was sent to her'.
3. **A. He was offered a job.** — Person first is more natural: 'He was offered a job'.
4. **A. We have been told the news.** — Present perfect passive, person first: 'We have been told the news'.
5. **A. to** — Thing as subject takes 'to': 'sent to every customer'.
6. **A. The visitors will be shown the garden.** — Future passive, person first: 'The visitors will be shown the garden'.
7. **A. I was given a second chance.** — Don't repeat the object: 'I was given a second chance'.
8. **A. A prize was given to the winner.** — Thing as subject needs 'to': 'given to the winner'.
9. **A. The one starting with the person (She was sent an email).** — English tends to put the person first: 'She was sent an email'.
10. **A. arrive** — 'Arrive' has no object at all, so no two-object passive.